Lesson 15 material: Indigenous People: Discussion, Listening and Reading

5.1: Discussion

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/02%3A_Unit_2._American_History/05%3A_Indigeonous_People/5.01%3A_Discussion
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Answer the following questions based on your experience and opinion. Read five classmates' posts and respond to two classmates pointing out any similarities or differences, asking clarifying questions, or giving your opinion on a point they make.

1. Think about the countries around the world. Who is indigenous to those lands? Who occupied those lands? Provide examples.
2. Think about the groups of people in the United States. How did the US become so diverse?
3. Are you familiar with the history of how minoritized groups in the US (e.g., Indigenous people, African Americans, Asian Americans, Muslims, Sikhs, immigrants, refugees, etc.) have been treated? Explain.

5.2: Listening-Lakota in America

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/02%3A_Unit_2._American_History/05%3A_Indigeonous_People/5.02%3A_Listening-Lakota_in_America
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

2.1.2.1. Exercise 1-Listening Comprehension

Watch the video Lakota in America and build a basic understanding to prepare you for this chapter's reading. Answer the questions to check your comprehension.

1. Select all the ways the Cheyenne River Youth Project helps youth.
a. Mental Health
b. Physical Health
c. Education
d. Financial Literacy
2. Select the challenges Lakota people reservation face.
a. Poverty
b. Alcoholism and substance abuse
c. Suicide
d. Unemployment
e. Housing
3. Why was the Lakota culture being lost?
a. It was illegal to practice the Lakota culture and religion.
b. The youth weren't interested in learning.
c. The elders weren't interested in passing down the traditions.
4. What is seen as wealth for Lakota people?
a. Money
b. Culture and tradition
c. Houses and cars
5. How many internships were completed in 2017?
a. 50
b. 100
c. 250
d. 500

"Lakota in America" is copyright by Square.

To learn more about important topics related to Indigenous people in the United States, watch these videos: North Dakota Access Pipeline (What Really Happened at Standing Rock: I Was There); Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women (Indigenous Women Keep Going Missing in Montana); Residential Schools (How the US Stole Thousands of Native American Children). The reading discusses life on a reservation. How do Indigenous people feel about reservations? Watch this video on word associations (Reservation/Native Americans/One Word/Cut).

Links on the original page

- Lakota in America: https://youtu.be/ie4m9LAVDGw
- North Dakota Access Pipeline: https://youtu.be/J1yD2J8vHAk
- Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women: https://youtu.be/ib0GDAPeymo
- Residential Schools: https://youtu.be/UGqWRyBCHhw
- video on word associations: https://youtu.be/OOWUDM1GBhk

5.3: Reading-Life on Reservations

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/02%3A_Unit_2._American_History/05%3A_Indigeonous_People/5.03%3A_Reading-Life_on_Reservations
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

2.1.3.1. Exercise 2-Reading Comprehension

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

1About 5.2 million Native Americans live in the United States, and 22% of those live on Native American Reservations. Reservations are large areas of land governed only by Native American tribes; the federal government has little control in these areas. Reservations have existed since 1830, although they have changed in size and location since then.

2.1.3.1.1. Why Reservations?

2The U.S. government created reservations to keep more land available for use by U.S. citizens as settlers moved west. Before the arrival of European settlers, Native Americans lived in tribes all over the continent and governed themselves. Each tribe had its own government, culture, traditions, family structures, and ways of life. When settlers began pushing farther and farther west, they fought with Native Americans who already lived there over who should have rights to the land.

3To "solve" these disputes about the control of land, the U.S. government "reserved" relatively small areas of land for Native Americans, while allowing the larger areas to be used by U.S. citizens. As more settlers traveled West and as natural resources such as gold and silver were found, the areas reserved for Native Americans became smaller and smaller. If Native Americans did not willingly move onto reservations, they were often relocated by force. The "Trail of Tears" was a series of forced relocations of Native Americans in the southeastern United States to areas that were west of the Mississippi. Over 4,000 Native Americans died from either starvation or disease while they were being relocated. Once tribes arrived on the reservation, there were problems as well, because sometimes feuding tribes ended up living on the same reservation.

4The U.S. government tried to install its own forms of education, work, and family life onto the reservations to weaken the Native Americans connection to their cultures and tribes. Many younger generations became disconnected from their heritage. This caused many problems for Native Americans in the following decades.

2.1.3.1.2. Reservation Life Today

5Many tribes continue to practice key parts of their distinct cultures. Even though many Native American religious and ancestral traditions were centered around land that they are no longer allowed to live on, many tribes maintain a sense of pride in their culture in numerous ways.

6One of the most important ways to do this is through the preservation of tribal languages. Since some of the languages have been lost completely, historians have been able to piece them back together using early recordings of folk tales and legends. Some tribes have programs that allow young students to experience daily language immersion with elders who learned the original language growing up.

7Important cultural events still exist on most reservations. For example, on Cherokee reservations in Georgia and Missouri, communities come together to perform traditional stomp dances and play an ancient game called stickball.

(Picture: Image 13 "Dream Catcher" by Brent from Texas is licensed under CC BY-NC.)

8Perhaps the most common cultural event on reservations across the country is the pow-wow. A pow-wow is a community event where there is singing, dancing, and ceremonies to celebrate Native American culture. No one is sure which tribe actually started the practice so many hundreds of years ago, but over time each tribe evolved its own spin on the tradition. Today, pow-wows happen all over the country, and many tribes come together to form bigger pow-wows to celebrate both their similarities and differences with each other.

9Life on reservations also has its share of problems. Because of the unique history of reservations, many of them face serious economic and social struggles.

2.1.3.1.3. Economic Challenges

10Some of the poorest places in America are reservations. The Pine Ridge Indian Reservation, located in South Dakota, is the poorest of the reservations; with a reported average annual income of less than $4,000 per family. Eight in ten adults don't have a job. Not all reservations are as economically disadvantaged as Pine Ridge, but many have unemployment rates in the double digits, and many households rely only on government benefits for income.

11Because there are so few job opportunities within the bounds of the reservations, it is not uncommon for parents to live elsewhere for at least part of the year in order to earn money. Meanwhile, they have to leave their children with other relatives or friends. All the economic hardship strains family relationships.

12Native Americans also face difficult living conditions. Most reservations have severe housing shortages – a wait list for a house could be up to three years long. Because of this, whole extended families crowd into existing houses, sleeping on couches and floors. Many live without the many utilities that most of America takes for granted. For example, over 50% of houses on reservations are not even connected to public sewers, and some have no running water.

2.1.3.1.4. Physical and Mental Health

13There are also many health issues among people living on reservations. Tuberculosis and diabetes rates are very high. On top of this, government-funded health care only meets about 60% of people's needs. Life expectancies are about four years lower than in the rest of the nation. The life expectancy on the Pine Ridge Indian Reservation is 48 years for men and 52 for women, which are the second-lowest averages in the entire western hemisphere.

14One of the most damaging diseases on reservations is alcoholism. The exact numbers are disputed, but alcohol addiction is notoriously high on many of the reservations, despite laws against the sale and purchase of liquor. Addiction to alcohol not only hurts (and sometimes kills) the addicts themselves, it is also stressful for their families, and it can even lead to domestic violence.

2.1.3.1.5. Stress and School

15All of these issues contribute to perhaps the greatest problem facing most reservations: poor education systems. The schools themselves are under-maintenanced and underfunded, and students score substantially lower on math and reading tests than students in the rest of the country. Most of the schools do not have enough computers or internet bandwidth to meet national standards.

16Interestingly, Native American students who participate in the immersion programs mentioned at the beginning of this article often have higher academic performance and test scores later in life than students who did not receive dual-language education. Some school reformers believe this indicates that if schools continue to integrate more of the unique Native American culture into their own classrooms, more students will improve.

1. PART A: Which of the following identifies the central idea of the text?

a. Life on reservations has vastly improved due to the involvement of the United States government.

b. Native Americans continue to face significant challenges on reservations that negatively impact their quality of life.

c. Most Native Americans eventually leave reservations due to the lack of opportunity and unsafe environments.

d. While reservation schools have less funding, they are more successful due to their integration of Native American cultures in the classroom.

2. PART B: Which detail from the text best supports the answer to Part A?

a. "The U.S. government tried to install its own forms of education, work, and family life onto the reservations to weaken the Native Americans connection to their cultures and tribes." (Paragraph 4)

b. "Not all reservations are as economically disadvantaged as Pine Ridge, but many have unemployment rates in the double digits, and many households rely only on government benefits for income." (Paragraph 10)

c. "Many live without the many utilities most of America takes for granted. For example, over 50% of houses on reservations are not even connected to public sewers, and some have no running water." (Paragraph 12)

d. "Native American students who participate in the immersion programs mentioned at the beginning of this article often have higher academic performance and test scores later in life than students who did not receive dual language education." (Paragraph 16)

3. PART A: How does the section "Economic Challenges" contribute to the development of ideas in the text (Paragraphs 10-12)?

a. It shows how the economic issues that Native Americans face on reservations result in several other related problems.

b. It emphasizes the need for additional jobs to be available on reservations so families are not separated.

c. It proves that the reservations need additional funding from the U.S. government to fulfill their basic needs.

d. It shows that not all reservations across the country are struggling, and that quality of life can vary dramatically.

4. PART B: Which quote from the text best supports the answer to Part A?

a. "Not all reservations are as economically disadvantaged as Pine Ridge, but many have unemployment rates in the double digits" (Paragraph 10)

b. "Meanwhile, they have to leave their children with other relatives or friends. All the economic hardship strains family relationships." (Paragraph 11)

c. "Most reservations have severe housing shortages – a wait list for a house could be up to three years long." (Paragraph 12)

d. "[O]ver 50% of houses on reservations are not even connected to public sewers, and some have no running water." (Paragraph 12)

"Life on Reservations" by Jessica McBirney is licensed by CommonLit under CC BY-NC-SA 2.0

Links on the original page

- Life on Reservations: https://www.commonlit.org/en/texts/life-on-reservations
- CommonLit: https://www.commonlit.org/en

16.4: Chapter 4

From *High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students* by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Rebecca Al Haider via source content that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.
Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/High-Intermediate_Academic_Grammar_for_ESL_Students_(Al_Haider)/05%3A_Appendices/Appendix_B%3A_Audio_Transcripts/16.04%3A_Chapter_4
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

4.4.1. Listening Comprehension

00:08 Genevieve: I was probably 11 or 12 at the time.

00:11 And my uncle, Emmet, passed away.

00:16 My mom got really depressed.

00:18 She started drinking really bad and she started treating us different.

00:24 There was this guy, he was just… some kind of stranger.

00:28 All of a sudden he started staying around more

00:30 and she left me and my two brothers at home alone…for…days on end.

00:37 One day that man, he was in the back room with my mom.

00:41 I heard them talking about shooting up something.

00:44 So I texted my grandma and I told her what was going on,

00:46 she said "hold on we'll come get you."

00:49 So I got up my brothers really, really fast.

00:51 I just put, like, any clothes on them I could find.

00:55 And I packed a bag…and we left.

01:05 "Ooh, look at that fly.

01:06 I'm lightning speed, that's why my name's "Lightning.'"

01:11 (laughs)

01:14 "I don't know how to work these."

01:15 "You just click play."

01:16 "Okay, cool."

01:28 "Oh, I'm off beat!

01:30 Hold on."

01:32 "You always have to turn when the double beats come in."

01:38 My name is Genevieve Iron Lightning.

01:40 My Lakota Name is Thˇokáhe Nážiŋ Wiŋ or "Stands First Woman."

01:45 And I'm the descendant of Chief Iron Lightning.

01:49 I kinda was born dancing.

01:51 It makes me feel connected, like, I'm in touch with my ancestors and my culture.

02:00 "And this is when she first got Mini Miss.

02:03 Ooh, you look like me in there.

02:05 (laughs) "What does it say on the sash, 2006?"

02:07 "It says Mini Me" "2006!"

02:11 (laughs) "This is her, um, picture from last year.

02:13 Is this last year's?"

02:15 "Yeah…my freshman year didn't turn out good."

02:25 It's difficult living in Eagle Butte.

02:27 It's difficult living on a reservation.

02:31 The houses aren't very nice, there's trash in the yards.

02:35 Broken and busted cars in the driveways.

02:39 Parents don't really take care of their kids,

02:40 unless, you know, I don't know, unless they have a job.

02:48 Julie: Cheyenne River has the unfortunate distinction

02:51 of being one of the poorest counties in the nation.

02:57 That's overwhelming when you think about it.

03:02 How do we get by?

03:05 Many of our people turn to alcohol.

03:08 Most recently, meth has become a really big issue in our community.

03:14 But you know, we didn't create the situation here.

03:19 They put us on these reservations to contain us, to control us, to keep us segregated.

03:28 And so as a result, we have a population of people

03:30 who don't have access to economic resources.

03:35 Julie: When you have poverty and addiction, it's

03:38 very easy to forget that there's little kids sitting next to you that need to be acknowledged,

03:44 and hugged and talked to.

03:49 Children are...a reflection of the surroundings that they're in.

03:56 Children need to be seen.

03:59 They need people guiding them, loving them.

04:02 And they need opportunity

04:14 My first summer here, my grandma was reading the newspaper and she saw something about

04:18 internships at the Cheyenne River Youth Project.

04:21 They were looking for people to work in the cafe that just opened that same summer.

04:26 So my grandma's like, "Hey I'm going to get you into that."

04:32 Julie: The Cheyenne River Youth Project is 100% about

04:35 being a positive influence on the kids of our community.

04:39 Within our facilities, we offer internships, wellness programs, the arts.

04:45 We have a teen center, a gymnasium, dance studio, computer lab.

04:50 We also have the Winyan Toka Win garden.

04:55 We're talking about their mental health, their physical health, their education.

05:00 All these different pieces that help them grow.

05:07 When CRYP first started, there wasn't a youth organization here.

05:13 And then over the years as we've evolved we've learned from our kids and from our

05:17 community about what the needs are.

05:22 It's important that we help them to understand the history

05:25 and who we are as a people, as Lakota people.

05:30 Moving us to reservations and the assimilation of our people.

05:34 All these things still impact us today.

05:39 Wakiya: Every other nationality in America were free

05:42 to practice their culture in anyway they saw fit, but not us as Native Americans.

05:49 It was against the law.

05:52 "Kill the Indian and save the man."

05:54 We're still dealing with that today.

05:58 (Lakota language) Always remember that you're Lakota first.

06:07 Julie: It's important for our young people to remember where they come from.

06:12 That's what our ancestors would want.

06:14 We want them to impart that onto their children when the next generation comes.

06:34 Julie: When you have poverty added to the historical trauma.

06:41 It's just...a kind of big...mess.

06:50 A problem with a lot of our kids is that you just reach a breaking point

06:55 when you don't know what to do.

06:57 And if there's nobody there to support you, to get you through these tough times...

07:03 then sometimes things happen.

07:08 In the last month, we had at east two completed suicides.

07:16 There were something like ten attempts.

07:21 It's like we have room for death but we don't have room for life.

07:29 You have to step into places that are uncomfortable

07:31 in order to do the work that we're trying to do with our kids.

07:36 They deserve more.

07:54 Julie: The picture I want to paint is that we have

07:56 our challenges but we are lifting ourselves up.

08:03 Our internships at CRYP provide a way out for our young people.

08:13 You know, we're teaching them about the business, they're learning their interpersonal

08:17 communication skills and how to manage money.

08:21 They also learn about writing resumes.

08:24 All those pieces that help a kid to prepare for the future.

08:30 Genevieve: Job opportunities are limited on the reservation,

08:33 so Keya Cafe and the other internships set you up for different job experiences.

08:41 Julie: We're giving them confidence

08:42 in how to go find a job or maybe they can have their own business.

08:47 We want them to imagine the possibilities.

08:52 "Oh my gosh, I'm spilling it."

08:54 I come over here at 7 and I get done at 2, and that was like...tiring for me.

09:00 But, earning your own money, it makes you feel like you're growing up,

09:06 it makes you feel independent.

09:16 The internships help you prepare for life after high school.

09:22 I am definitely gonna go to college and I will come back and help my community in any way I can.

09:28 Because, it's a struggle here, but it's my home.

09:52 Genevieve: My grandma, her dad is Grant Iron Lightning Jr.,

09:56 her grandpa is Grant Iron Lightning Sr.,

09:59 and then I can't remember his dad's name,

10:01 but it's five generations back is Chief Iron Lightning.

10:04 He could walk anywhere and he could just come back with horses.

10:09 And that made him a leader to the Lakota people.

10:13 "And this is where my great grandpa Iron Lightning was buried.

10:17 This is Dale Iron Lighting, he was one of my uncles.

10:21 That's who I was named after."

10:23 Genevieve: Knowing that I come from these great people,

10:2 I feel like I have to do big things, ya know?

10:31 (singing)

11:42 I want to set a good example for the younger generations, ya know?

11:47 To show them that I did struggle here,

11:51 but I did the youth internships at CRYP.

11:54 I did anything in my power to make something of myself.

12:00 I like that feeling of doing something right, ya know?

12:05 It makes my people proud and I like making my people proud.

12:16 Julie: Our dream and our idea of success and wealth is…

12:21 just different.

12:24 I think we see family and culture and tradition and singing and dancing as…wealth.

12:39 Being Lakota, we've had this oppressive weight for all these years.

12:48 But this generation of kids is…

12:52 different.

12:56 They're proud of who we are.

12:59 They're proud to be Lakota.

13:03 They're not afraid to speak up.

13:07 To change what's happening for us.

13:11 And let the world know that we are still here.

13:18 They are the next culture bearers.

13:22 The next leaders.

13:25 They're a powerful new generation.

13:32 "I got it, we're connected!"

13:34 There's so much they've overcome.

13:38 Imagine the possibilities if we can help them grow

13:43 and give them the skills to go out into the world and thrive.

"Lakota in America" is copyright by Square.

4.4.2. Exercise-Listening Practice

When I was a child, I used to live on a farm. My family had over 350 animals. I had to feed them every evening when I returned home from school even when the weather was cold and wet. Because of this enormous responsibility, I could not hang out with my friends on weekdays. Instead, I would visit them on weekends. Working on a farm gave me great physical strength. I could lift heavy bags of grain and shovel dirt easily.

Links on the original page

- Lakota in America: https://youtu.be/ie4m9LAVDGw